

Endava Vietnam Software Development Internship: Behavioral Interview Q&A

1. Tell me about yourself

Mindset

- Focus on your academic and personal background that is relevant to software development. Briefly mention your current studies (e.g. computer science, engineering) and any relevant coursework in programming (especially Java or C++).
- Highlight strengths or achievements from school that relate to the role (e.g. top grades in coding courses, participation in programming clubs). Emphasize qualities like **curiosity, teamwork, and willingness to learn**.
- Keep your answer concise and structured. Think of it as a short story: **context (your background) → key experience or skill → goal or aspiration (how it relates to the internship)**. This helps the interviewer see why you're a good fit.
- Interviewers want to hear a narrative that showcases why you are interested in this internship and what unique qualities you bring. Avoid personal details unrelated to the job.

Sample Answer

"I am currently a third-year Computer Science student at [University], where I've built a strong foundation in programming and algorithms. In my coursework, I've focused on object-oriented programming using Java and C++, and I've completed projects like developing a simple database application and a text-based game. Through these projects I learned how to break down complex problems and write clean, maintainable code. **I'm excited to apply these skills in a real-world setting at Endava,** where I can learn from experienced engineers. Ultimately, I hope to grow my technical skills and contribute to useful software solutions as part of your team."

2. Why are you interested in this internship at Endava?

Mindset

- Demonstrate that you have researched Endava and are enthusiastic about the company. You might mention Endava's reputation for technology innovation, its inclusive culture, or specific technologies they work with. For example, you could say you admire Endava's focus on continuous learning and building real-world solutions.
- Connect your interests and career goals to what Endava offers. Emphasize **learning and growth** – for instance, say you value Endava's training programs or mentorship opportunities.
- Show passion and fit: Explain how your skills and aspirations align with the internship. For example, if you enjoy collaborative projects, say that you are eager to join a collaborative team environment like Endava's.

- Structure your answer by stating why the role excites you, what you can contribute, and what you hope to gain. This shows awareness of the company's values and how you'll add value.

Sample Answer

"I'm very interested in this internship at Endava because I value **collaborative learning environments and innovative software projects**. I know Endava emphasizes mentorship and technology growth, which is important to me as a new developer. During my studies, I've gained experience in Java and C++ and I'm eager to apply that knowledge in real projects. I admire Endava's commitment to continuous learning and making a positive impact through technology. **I believe this internship would allow me to contribute my coding skills to meaningful projects while learning best practices from experienced engineers**, which aligns perfectly with my career goals."

3. Describe a time when you worked as part of a team.

Mindset

- Use the STAR framework to structure your response: **Situation** (the team project context), **Task** (your role or responsibility), **Action** (what you did), and **Result** (what the team achieved). The Muse emphasizes that the STAR method helps provide a focused answer ¹.
- Focus on collaboration: explain how you **communicated with teammates, shared responsibilities, and integrated your work**. For example, mention using version control (like Git) or how you coordinated meetings.
- Highlight your **specific contribution** (e.g. writing code, researching a solution, organizing tasks) and any positive outcome (project delivered on time, got a good grade, etc.).
- Interviewers look for evidence that you can work well with others. For instance, a guide notes to *"discuss a project where you worked closely with others to achieve a goal"* ² and how you handled differing opinions. Show that you listened to teammates and adapted.

Sample Answer

"In one class project, my team of four had to build a simple library management system in Java. **My task was to implement the backend search and database integration**. First, we held a kickoff meeting to assign roles: I worked on the search functions, one teammate handled the database schema, another built the user interface, and the fourth worked on user authentication. We used GitHub for version control and had weekly check-ins. Whenever we faced a problem (for example, a conflict in database queries), I helped organize a group debugging session. In the end, **we delivered a working prototype on time and received positive feedback from the professor**. Through this experience, I learned the importance of clear communication and dividing tasks so each team member could contribute effectively."

4. Tell me about a time you had a disagreement or conflict with a teammate. How did you handle it?

Mindset

- Pick an example that shows maturity in conflict resolution. Again use STAR: describe the **Situation** (project and conflict), **Task** (need to resolve it), **Action** (steps you took), and **Result** (how it turned out).
- **Emphasize communication and empathy.** For instance, mention that you scheduled a private discussion to understand the other person's viewpoint, which is a common recommended approach ³. Show that you listened actively and sought a compromise rather than arguing.
- Interviewers want to see that you stay professional and solution-focused. A sample answer recommended scheduling a meeting to understand a colleague's perspective and then finding a compromise ³. Demonstrate a similar approach: calmly explain your side and be open to feedback.
- Highlight the positive outcome: perhaps you combined ideas or agreed on a plan that satisfied everyone, leading to project progress. This shows you can turn conflict into constructive teamwork ².

Sample Answer

"During a software engineering lab project, I disagreed with a teammate about how to design our class structure. He preferred one approach, but I felt an alternative design would be more scalable. Instead of arguing, I **suggested we meet over lunch to discuss our ideas calmly**. During the meeting, I listened to his reasoning and then explained my perspective, focusing on the benefits of my approach. We realized both ideas had merits, so we **compromised by merging the two designs**: I implemented one part of the functionality and he implemented another, then we integrated them. In the end, our solution worked well, and we submitted the project on time. This experience taught me the value of open dialogue and willingness to adapt for the good of the team."

5. Describe a situation where you had to quickly learn a new skill or technology.

Mindset

- Highlight your **willingness to learn and adaptability**. Use STAR to frame the story: Situation (new skill needed), Task (need to learn it quickly), Action (how you learned), Result (outcome).
- Explain **why you needed to learn** (e.g. a class project required a new tool, or you wanted to solve a problem more effectively). Then describe your learning process: perhaps you broke the topic into smaller parts, used online tutorials or documentation, and practiced by writing code. This shows problem-solving in learning.
- Interviewers often look for **initiative and problem-solving** when you tackle new challenges ⁴. For example, they want to know if you can systematically approach a complex problem. Emphasize that you remained organized and resourceful (e.g. "I set aside daily study time and wrote example programs to test my understanding").
- End with the positive result: you successfully applied the new skill. This demonstrates you can quickly get up to speed, which is valuable for interns who must learn on the job.

Sample Answer

"In one of my final exams, we were required to implement algorithms in C++, but I had only used Java in class up to that point. **I decided to learn C++ basics in a short time.** First, I reviewed online tutorials to grasp syntax differences, focusing on object-oriented features and memory management in C++. Then, I practiced by converting a simple Java program I had written into C++ to get hands-on experience. I also consulted my professor's office hours when I got stuck on pointer usage. Within a few days, I felt comfortable with the basics of C++. As a result, I was able to complete the exam's coding tasks correctly. This experience showed me that by breaking down what I need to learn and practicing actively, I can quickly acquire new programming skills."

6. Tell me about a time you made a mistake or faced a failure. What did you do, and what did you learn?

Mindset

- Be honest and choose a real mistake (academic or personal project). Use STAR: Situation (context), Task (what you were trying to do), Action (the mistake and how you addressed it), Result (outcome and learning).
- Emphasize **responsibility and learning**. Interviewers expect that mistakes happen, but they want to see that you own up to them and correct them ⁵. For instance, you might describe finding a bug in your code shortly before a deadline, admitting the error, and then taking steps to fix it.
- Show what you learned. Did you implement a new check or test procedure? For example, many candidates mention they learned to double-check requirements or to write unit tests after a coding error. This demonstrates you have a growth mindset and won't repeat the same mistake.
- Keep the tone positive: focus more on the resolution and lessons rather than blaming circumstances. This question tests your integrity and ability to improve from setbacks ⁵.

Sample Answer

"In a programming assignment, I once submitted code that failed all tests because I had misunderstood the requirements. **I realized my mistake when reviewing the feedback.** I immediately acknowledged the issue and asked my instructor for help to clarify the requirements. Then I updated my code according to the correct specifications, tested it thoroughly, and resubmitted. In doing so, I learned how crucial it is to fully understand a problem before coding. Since then, I always outline the requirements and write some pseudocode first. This experience taught me to communicate quickly when I'm unsure and to adopt better testing habits, so I can catch mistakes early on."

7. How do you prioritize and manage your time when facing multiple tasks or deadlines?

Mindset

- This question assesses your **time-management and organizational skills**. Describe concrete strategies you use. For example: creating a to-do list, setting milestones, using a calendar, or breaking tasks into smaller steps.

- Use STAR if possible: Situation (e.g. multiple deadlines), Task (complete them all), Action (how you scheduled and prioritized), Result (all tasks done on time).
- Mention tools and methods: maybe you use digital calendars or apps, or you plan tasks the night before. This shows proactivity. For instance, you might say you set reminders and allocate specific time blocks for each task.
- Emphasize flexibility: explain that when unexpected changes happen, you reassess priorities. This demonstrates problem-solving under pressure. According to interview advice, discuss specific strategies like planning and scheduling to show you can meet deadlines ⁶.
- Interviewers want to see that you can handle a demanding internship schedule, so highlight examples from school where you successfully juggled responsibilities.

Sample Answer

“During my last semester, I had two programming assignments and midterm exams all in the same week. **I knew I had to plan carefully to meet each deadline.** I started by listing all tasks and their due dates, then broke each assignment into smaller milestones (design, coding, testing). I used a digital calendar to allocate dedicated study blocks for each task and set reminders. For example, after one coding block, I spent the next break reviewing lecture notes to stay fresh. If something took longer than planned, I adjusted by re-prioritizing the remaining tasks. **In the end, I submitted all my work on time and performed well on the exams.** This experience taught me that careful planning and adaptability are key to managing multiple deadlines.”

8. What is your greatest strength and your biggest weakness?

Mindset

- For **strength**, choose a quality relevant to the role (e.g. problem-solving, analytical skills, teamwork, or willingness to learn). Provide a brief example that illustrates it. Keep the focus on how this strength benefits your work (e.g. “I’m detail-oriented, which helps me catch errors in code”).
- For **weakness**, pick a real area where you can improve, but one that doesn’t make you unfit for the job (e.g. public speaking, being too detail-focused). Importantly, immediately explain what you do to mitigate it. Indeed recommends “*combining self-awareness with an action plan*” when discussing weaknesses ⁷. For example: “I can be overly detail-oriented, but I’ve been practicing setting time limits on tasks so I stay on schedule.”
- Structure: first mention strength positively, then honestly state your weakness followed by what you’ve done to improve. This shows self-awareness and growth mindset.
- Interviewers are looking for **honesty and balance**. They want to see that you are introspective and striving to get better ⁷. Avoid clichés like “I have no weaknesses.” Instead, show genuine reflection.

Sample Answer

“One of my greatest strengths is **analytical problem-solving**. In my coursework, I often find that breaking a complex program into smaller parts helps me identify issues quickly. For example, on a data structures project, this approach helped me optimize our code to run more efficiently. As for a weakness, I sometimes spend too much time perfecting details, which can slow me down. **To improve this, I’ve been setting personal time limits for each task** and using checklists to ensure I focus on the bigger picture. This way, I maintain high quality without sacrificing efficiency.”

9. Give an example of a situation where you took initiative or went above and beyond what was required.

Mindset

- Choose an example that shows **proactivity and leadership potential**, even if it's not a formal leadership role. Use STAR: Situation (what needed to be done), Task (what you decided to do extra), Action (steps you took), Result (impact).
- Emphasize identifying a problem or opportunity on your own. Maybe you **started a new process or helped others** without being asked. According to hiring guides, companies value candidates who *"take responsibility for outcomes"* and *"take initiative beyond basic duties"* ⁸ ⁹.
- Describe concrete actions: perhaps you organized a study group, volunteered to fix a bug outside your assignment scope, or improved documentation for the class. Explain how this initiative had a positive effect (better team performance, time saved, etc.).
- Interviewers want to see that you won't just do the minimum. Show enthusiasm and ownership: explain that you looked ahead and contributed extra effort to benefit the team or project.

Sample Answer

"In my algorithms class, we were working on individual problem sets, but I noticed some classmates were struggling with a particular concept. **I took the initiative to create a short tutorial and ran an optional study session after class.** I prepared examples in Java to explain the concept step-by-step and answered questions. Several classmates attended and gave feedback that it helped clarify the topic. As a result, the whole group performed better on the next assignment. **By volunteering this extra session, I demonstrated initiative and helped the entire team succeed.**"

¹ How to Use the STAR Method to Ace Your Job Interview | The Muse
<https://www.themuse.com/advice/star-interview-method>

² ⁴ ⁸ ⁹ Behavioral Interviews at FAANG: What They're Really Looking For
<https://www.designgurus.io/blog/behavioral-interviews-at-faang>

³ ⁵ ⁶ 10 Behavioral Interview Questions (With Sample Answers) | Indeed.com
<https://www.indeed.com/career-advice/interviewing/behavioral-interview-questions>

⁷ Weaknesses for Job Interviews: 10 Example Answers | Indeed.com
<https://www.indeed.com/career-advice/interviewing/list-of-example-weaknesses-for-interviewing>